



School of Science and Technology

BIOL 1102 Section 05 (50346)

Biological Sciences II

2026 Summer

Course Description and Prerequisites

Prerequisites: HSGPA ≥ 3.2 or ACT MATH ≥ 17 or SAT MATH ≥ 400 or ACCM ≥ 67 or COMM ≥ 37 or MATH 1001* or MATH 1111* AND HSGPA ≥ 3.1 or ACT English ≥ 17 or SAT Cr Reading ≥ 430 or COMR ≥ 74 and SEGX ≥ 8 or ACCR ≥ 61 and ACCW ≥ 4 or ENGL 1101, or ENGL 1101* or ENGL 1101^ or ENGL 1101H concurrently. Part of the two-semester sequence of basic biology for non-science majors. Upon completion of this course, students will: (1) describe the organization of life from the organism to the biosphere; (2) demonstrate critical thinking skills and the scientific process; (3) effectively collect and analyze data and draw conclusions; (4) apply scientific concepts to global issues and perspectives, and distinguish between well-documented scientific studies and popular opinion; (5) communicate scientific topics effectively in oral and written form.

Core IMPACTS

This course is part of Core IMPACTS.

Core IMPACTS consists of seven core curriculum domains (previously identified as areas A-E). Each Core IMPACTS domain is designed around a specific orienting question (goal or topic), learning outcomes, and career-ready competencies.

IMPACTS Domain: Technology, Mathematics and Science

IMPACTS Statement: This is a Core IMPACTS course that is part of the Technology, Mathematics and Science domain.

Orienting Question(s): How do I ask scientific questions or use data, mathematics, or technology to understand the universe?

Learning Outcome(s): Students will use the scientific method and laboratory procedures or mathematical and computational methods to analyze data, solve problems, and explain natural phenomena.

Career-Ready Competencies: Inquiry and Analysis, Problem-Solving, & Teamwork

Course Outcomes

Students who have successfully completed the course will:

1. Describe the organization of life from the organism to the biosphere.
2. Demonstrate critical thinking skills and the scientific process.
3. Effectively collect and analyze data and draw conclusions.
4. Apply scientific concepts to global issues and perspectives, and distinguish between well-documented scientific studies and popular opinion.
5. Communicate scientific topics effectively in oral and written form.

The IEE Goals met by the objectives of this course are:

- **IEE-1: Clearly communicate ideas in written and oral form.**
- **IEE-2: Demonstrate creativity and critical thinking in inter- and multi-disciplinary contexts.**
- **IEE-3: Demonstrate effective use of information technology.**
- **IEE-8: Demonstrate competence in quantitative reasoning.**

School Information

Vision Statement

The School of Science and Technology (SST) will become recognized in the region and the state for excellence in STEM education at an open access institution. SST faculty will provide effective and relevant courses and

programs in science, math, and technology which are characterized by interdisciplinary learning, novel use of educational technology, and an active learning environment that stimulates critical thinking.

Mission Statement

The School of Science and Technology is committed to providing an innovative outcomes-based learning experience for all students of Georgia Gwinnett College. It provides programs of study in biology, math, exercise science, and information technology that offer its students disciplinary and interdisciplinary courses, as well as practical and applied learning experiences that prepare them for post-graduate schooling or for positions of responsibility in education, business, medicine or government. The SST also provides general education experiences that produce graduates who demonstrate math, science, and information technology literacy, and that foster an understanding of the role of these disciplines in our society and in an uncertain and changing world. The School's faculty maintain competency in their discipline and are knowledgeable of methods of providing innovative active-learning environments.

School of Science and Technology Policies

Class Attendance and Financial Aid

Please be aware that faculty check attendance in each of your courses and are required to report to the Registrar students who never attend or cease attending a course. Students who are reported as never attended or have ceased attending a course, Financial Aid will be notified and is required to adjust your financial aid award accordingly. If you have any questions about how not attending a course for which you are registered will affect your financial aid eligibility, please contact the Financial Aid Office.

If you feel that you are unable to complete your courses due to illness or family emergency, contact the Registrar's Office to attempt to withdraw from your courses without penalty.

Health & Safety Policy

Certain laboratories include use of strong acids, solvents, and preservatives. Any pregnant women, hypersensitive individuals, or immunocompromised people should report their condition to the instructor and to their physician, preferably before contact with the materials (see lab exercises). Additional instructions for lab will be presented during the first lab. Students are required to follow all instructions. Students failing to conform to lab rules and safety precautions will be first warned by removal from the lab. On second offense, students will be removed from both lecture and lab

Social Media

Follow the School of Science and Technology on Facebook. You will hear about important events and information including Career Services events, scholarships, studies abroad opportunities, summer research opportunities, and employment opportunities.

Faculty Information

Name: Melissa Caspary

Email: mcaspary@ggc.edu

Office: A1172

Office Hours: Available by request or appointment.

Department: Biology

Curriculum Vitae:

[Curriculum Vitae](#)

Class Details

Course Details

BIOL 1102 Section 05 (50346)

Course Title: Biological Sciences II

Credit Hours: 3

Semester Start Date: 05/26/2026 **Semester End Date:** 07/23/2026

Course Start Date: 06/24/2026 **Course End Date:** 07/23/2026

Modality: Online Instruction

Final Exam Details

This asynchronous course will not have a final exam.

Online/Proctored Tests

This course requires the use of a proctored testing service/software such as [Respondus LockDown Browser](#), [Respondus Monitor](#), or [ProctorU](#), and a webcam for online exams. The webcam can be built into your computer or can be the type that plugs in with a USB cable. The software may require you to scan the room in which you are taking the test with your webcam. The video of the room scan is only available to me, as well as appropriate IT staff and administrators.

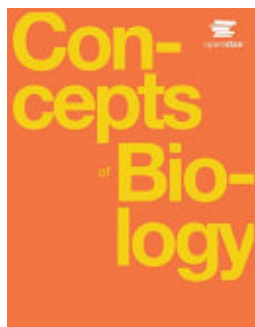
If you are at home and have privacy concerns about a webcam scan of your surroundings, you can take the test anywhere you feel comfortable. If you cannot identify such a place, contact me before the date of the test to arrange for a separate room on campus for testing.

Web Conferencing

This course will use [[Microsoft Teams](#) OR [Zoom](#)] for video conferencing sessions and collaboration activities.

Some or all of the sessions may be recorded. Recordings may be shared in accordance with [recording guidelines](#).

Required Course Materials

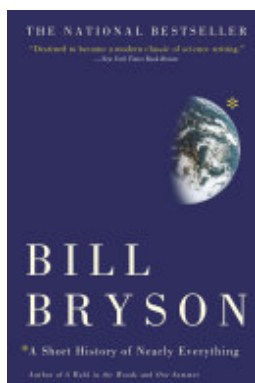


Concepts of Biology

ISBN: 9785021539470

Authors: Openstax

Publication Date: 2022-07-05



A Short History of Nearly Everything

ISBN: 9780767908184

Authors: Bill Bryson

Publisher: Crown

Publication Date: 2004-09-14

Recommended Course Materials

Ask Instructor

Resources Needed

Use the PULSE APP to help keep track of all your assignments and grades in MyCourses. (find in App store or use the link for more information).

<https://itservices.ggc.edu/pulse-app/>

Course Grading

Grading Scale:

Grading Scale• A (Excellent) 90-100• B (Good) 80-89• C (Fair) 70-79• D (Poor) 60-69• F (Failure) 59 and below

Grading Percentages

BIOL 1102 Classroom Component:

Book Chapter Reflections (25 pts. Each) 375 points or 47.5%

Other Assignments & Participation 175 points or 17.5%

Quizzes (15 Quizzes at 30 pts. each) 450 points or 45%

Total 1000 points or 100%

Quizzes: Quizzes will be worth 45% of your total final grade. These will be available from Thursday to Sunday each week. The content of these exams will come primarily from the book chapters and will consist of multiple choice/short answer/matching/diagrammatic questions. Given the flexibility of when you can take the weekly quizzes, no makeup quizzes will be offered (even for an excused absence).

Grades cannot and will not be changed at the discretion of the instructor at the end of the semester.

Late Work Policy: Quizzes will not be accepted late. Other homework submitted after the deadline will be accepted; however, 10% will be taken off for every day that an assignment or project is late.

Important Dates

Important Dates from the GGC Academic Calendar

Activity	Date
Tuition due Tuition and Fees Deadlines	May 21
Classes begin (Full Session and Session A)	May 26
Drop/add ends (Session A)	May 27
Drop/add ends (Full Session)	May 28
Mid-term grades due (Session A)	June 4
Last day to withdraw with "W" (Session A)	June 10
Classes end (Session A)	June 18
Juneteenth	June 19
Mid-term grades due (Full Session)	June 22
Final exams (Session A) Final exam schedules (login required)	June 22-23

Activity	Date
Classes begin (Session B)	June 24
Drop/add ends (Session B)	June 25
Last day to withdraw with "W" (Full Session)	June 25
Grades due (Session A)	June 26, 9 a.m.
Independence Day (observed)	July 3
Mid-term grades due (Session B)	July 7
Last day to withdraw with "W" (Session B)	July 9
Classes end (Full Session)	July 16
Classes end (Session B)	July 20
Final exams (Full Session)	July 20-23
Final exams (Session B) Final exam schedules (login required)	July 21-23
Grades due (Full Session and Session B)	July 27, Noon
Grades available in Grizzly Den within Banner	July 28

Course Outline/Assessments

N/A

Course Changes

This course syllabus provides a general plan for this course. I reserve the right to make changes to the syllabus, including changes to assignments, projects, examinations, etc., in order to accommodate the needs of the class as a whole and fulfill the goals of the course.

Expectations

To be successful in this course, you should:

- Read the syllabus in its entirety.
- Attend class daily.
- Arrive on time.

- Be prepared (complete readings and assignments) to engage in class discussions.
- Stow your devices or set them to silent to minimize disruptions.
- Check [MyCourses](#) each day for announcements, content, discussions, assignments, tests, grades, and more.
- Respond to my emails (check [Claw Mail](#) daily) in a timely manner using appropriate language and grammar.
- Use my office hours or schedule appointments to discuss concerns.
- Familiarize yourself with the Student Honor Statement:
We will not lie, steal, or cheat, nor tolerate the actions of those who do.

To support your success, I will:

- Provide office hours or appointment options in the Faculty Information section of the syllabus.
- Respond to your emails in a timely manner (see the Faculty Information section of the syllabus).
- Provide feedback and grades in a timely manner.
- Assist you with locating and engaging with resources provided by the college. This syllabus includes some suggestions. Keep reading for details.

Academic Integrity

GGC students are expected to demonstrate integrity and honesty in their courses and to complete work according to my expectations. You are responsible for avoiding every aspect or appearance of academic dishonesty. While it is impossible to list all acts of academic dishonesty, examples are listed below. Additional details on academic integrity are found in the [GGC Academic Policy Manual, Academic Integrity Policy for Academic Dishonesty Matters \(Policy 4.1.1.1.2\)](#).

Academic Dishonesty. Examples of specific prohibited actions include, but are not limited to, the following:

1. Academic Misconduct: Performing, attempting to perform, or assisting another in performing any act of academic dishonesty.
2. Cheating: This act of dishonesty includes, but is not limited to, giving information to or taking information from other students during examinations. Cheating is also committed when students copy from unauthorized sources and/or represent some other person's work as their own. Collaboration on out-of-class assignments or examinations is considered cheating unless specifically stated. The use of Artificial Intelligence ("AI") on any assignment submitted for credit is generally prohibited. See my statement on Artificial Intelligence Use below.
3. Plagiarism: This category includes copying material from unpublished or published sources, including electronic resources, and submitting that material as the student's own work. Students are responsible for identifying the proper source and for giving credit to that source anytime that they present ideas that are not their own.
4. Unauthorized Use or Possession of Materials or Resources: Students must not use or possess unauthorized materials or resources in an academic activity.
5. Collusion: This act of dishonesty includes, but is not limited to, buying or selling material that can be misrepresented as a student's own work. In addition, students who fail to report known acts of academic dishonesty on the part of others may be held responsible for collusion.
6. Previously submitted material: Students may not submit work that has been or is being concurrently submitted, in whole or in part, in another class without first having received permission to do so from all the professors involved.
7. Misrepresentation or falsification of material: This act includes, but is not limited to, misrepresenting, fabricating, or altering academic material. In addition, students must not take an examination or test in the name of another student or present another student's work as their own.
8. Misrepresentation of circumstances: Students must not misrepresent personal circumstances (e.g., illness, conflicting responsibilities, etc.)

to avoid meeting academic responsibilities or to gain an academic advantage.

To avoid plagiarism, you must appropriately cite the sources of others' ideas, thoughts, and words that appear in your original work. In addition to requesting assistance from the [Academic Enhancement Center](#), me, or trusted peers, you may use a variety of technologies to improve your writing. These tools, which may include proofreading and editing features of word processing software, do not alter your work to an extent that fundamentally affects your claim to authorship.

I may use the Originality Check feature of Turnitin to see how similar your work is to online sources and to assist you in learning how to cite sources appropriately to avoid potential plagiarism. I may also use applications to detect writing generated by artificial intelligence (AI). Some writing tools use AI to suggest edits, while other AI technologies, such as ChatGPT, are meant to simulate human conversation and produce writing that appears to be authored by a person. Although AI can be used for educational purposes and to develop or improve one's writing, submitting work containing AI-generated text, unless I request or explicitly allow it as part of an assignment, is prohibited. **See my statement on Artificial Intelligence Use below.**

All violations of the Academic Integrity Policy shall be resolved via the Faculty Adjudication Process and/or the Formal Resolution (Student Conduct Board hearing through the Dean of Students Office) as outlined in the [Academic Integrity Policy for Academic Dishonesty Matters \(Policy 4.1.1.1.2\)](#).

Artificial Intelligence

All students should be familiar with the college's policy on [Acceptable Use of Artificial Intelligence \(AI\) for Academic and Administrative Purposes](#) and the [Academic Integrity Policy for Academic Dishonesty Matters](#).

For this course, my expectation regarding the use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) is as follows:

Just say no to AI.

Attendance Policy and Absences

Attendance is a strong indicator of success in this class! Please plan to attend all class sessions and be on time. If you must be absent, please review the [college's attendance policy](#).

It is a best practice to inform me when you must be absent (see my preferred communication method) and discuss the option(s), if any, to make up missed assignments, tests, exams, etc. You do not have to share why you are absent with me directly. If you wish to provide documentation needed for the absence to be considered excused, you may [submit this to the Dean of Students](#), and they will work with you and me.

Complaints and Grade Appeals

If you have course-related issues, please schedule an appointment to meet with me. (See the Faculty Information above for contact details). If we are unable to resolve the issue you may contact the department chair. You may seek further assistance, if needed, through the Dean's office. The college also offers you the option to [file a written student complaint](#).

[Final grade appeals may also be filed](#) if you believe there is an error.

The student complaint process and the grade appeal process are both outlined in the [Student Handbook](#).

Learning Resources

The college offers services and resources designed to help you succeed.

[Academic Enhancement Center \(AEC\)](#)

The AEC provides [in-person tutoring](#), online tutoring via [Tutor.com](#), and structured study sessions known as [Peer Supplemental Instruction](#) (PSI), as well as academic coaches who can advise you on study, test-taking, and time management skills.

[Kaufman Library](#)

The Kaufman Library is home to [full-text articles](#), [e-books](#), [reports](#), [statistics](#), [and videos](#). The [librarians and library staff](#) are available to assist you with locating resources, research needs, course assignments, and more.

[Disability Services](#)

Disability Services provides reasonable accommodations to ensure accessible educational and social environments. If you believe you require an accommodation, [initiate a request for services](#).

[Information Technology](#)

You may contact the [Help Desk](#) if you experience issues with using the technology needed for this course. [Software](#), including [Microsoft Office 365](#) and [Adobe Express](#), is available for your use in [computer labs](#) and classrooms. If you need access to a laptop, the college offers a limited quantity, [need-based laptop loaner program](#).

[Access and Accommodations](#)

Access and Accommodations

It is important that all students have equal access to the classroom and their education. If you have already established accommodations with [Disability Services](#), please provide me with your Faculty Accommodation Notification, with your approved accommodations listed at your earliest convenience.

If you have not yet established services through Disability Services (located in D-1404), but have a permanent disability (such as, but not limited to: mental health, attention-related, learning, vision, hearing, physical, or health impacts), or a temporary condition that requires accommodations, you are encouraged to contact Disability Services at 678-407-5195 or disabilityservices@ggc.edu.

Disability Services offers resources and coordinates reasonable accommodations for students with disabilities and/or temporary health

conditions. Georgia Gwinnett College is committed to creating an inclusive and accessible learning environment consistent with federal and state law.

Pregnancy and Pregnancy-Related Conditions Accommodations Under Title IX

GGC is committed to compliance with Title IX and to supporting the academic success of pregnant students and students with pregnancy-related conditions (pregnancy, childbirth, loss of pregnancy, lactation, and all related medical conditions or recovery).

Students experiencing pregnancy or pregnancy-related conditions may request reasonable accommodations, including but not limited to excused absences, making up missed assignments, restroom breaks, a larger desk, lactation breaks, access to lactation spaces, etc. To request pregnancy-related accommodations, students should contact the Office of Disability Services (email: disabilityservices@ggc.edu; phone: 678-407-5883) or the [Office of Equal Opportunity and Title IX Compliance](#) (email: TitleIX@ggc.edu; phone: 678-407-5085).

Students who believe they have been subject to discrimination or harassment because of their pregnancy status or pregnancy-related condition(s) may file a complaint with the Office of Equal Opportunity and Title IX Compliance.

Well-being and Safety

The college offers many resources and services to support your physical and emotional well-being in a safe environment.

Student Emergency Assistance Programs

Our emergency assistance programs include:

- [Care Pantry](#)
Provides food and necessities to students experiencing financial constraints.
- [Grizzly Thrift](#)
Provides access to free clothing for students.

Health and Wellness Programs

Health Services offers a variety of services to help you stay well.

- [Medical Services](#)
Provides care for minor injuries and illnesses, diagnostic testing, immunizations, and basic over-the-counter medications.
- [Counseling and Psychological Services \(CAPS\)](#).
Provides mental health services.
- [Wellness and Recreation](#)
Provides workout facilities, fitness classes, and intramural sports.

Disability Services

Disability Services provides reasonable accommodations to ensure accessible educational and social environments. If you require an accommodation, [initiate a request for services](#).

Safety and Security

[Public Safety](#) offers many services to help you stay safe on campus, including safety escorts.

You'll want to stay informed about [campus closures and other safety-related notifications](#) via [Rave Alert](#).

Grizzly Care Team

The [Grizzly Care Team](#) brings together professionals from across the college to help you or other members of the college community who may pose a threat to the safety of the college community or an individual. If you see someone experiencing challenges, appearing distressed, posing a threat to their safety or someone else's safety, or causing a significant disruption to the GGC community, please [submit a Grizzly Care Team referral](#).

Equal Opportunity and Non-Discrimination Statement

Notice of Non-Discrimination

Georgia Gwinnett College is committed to providing a learning, working, and living environment that promotes personal integrity, civility, and mutual respect and is free of all forms of discrimination and harassment. In accordance with applicable law and Georgia Gwinnett College's Non-Discrimination and Anti-Harassment Policy, Georgia Gwinnett College prohibits discrimination on the basis of an individual's race, color, sex (including sexual harassment, marital, parental, and pregnancy status), sexual orientation, gender identity, gender expression, ethnicity or national origin, religion, age, genetic information, disability, creed, or veteran status ("protected status"), or any other protected status or characteristic as defined by law, in its programs and activities. No individual shall be excluded from participation in, denied the benefits of, or otherwise be subjected to unlawful discrimination, harassment, or retaliation under any GGC program or activity because of the individual's protected status.

Georgia Gwinnett College is an equal employment, equal access, and equal educational opportunity institution. It is the policy and practice of our institution to recruit, hire, train, promote, retain, and educate persons without regard to their protected status, as required by applicable state and federal laws (including Title VI, Title VII, Title IX, ADA, Sections 503 and 504 of the Rehabilitation Act, and Executive Order 11246).

Any individual who feels that they may have been discriminated against should contact the Equal Opportunity and Title IX Compliance office at titleix@ggc.edu or 678-407-5085.

Students requiring disability related accommodations, please contact [Disability Services](#).

The following person has been designated to handle inquiries regarding the non-discrimination policies:

Sharon Stellato, J.D., Interim Title IX Coordinator

Building B, Suite 3700

678.407.5085

TitleIX@ggc.edu

For more general information, please visit the [Equal Opportunity and Title IX Office's website](#).

Sexual Misconduct Statement

Title IX prohibits discrimination on the basis of sex in education programs or activities operated by recipients of Federal financial assistance. Georgia Gwinnett College is committed to creating a safe learning environment for all members of our community, free from gender and sex-based discrimination, including sexual harassment, domestic and dating violence, sexual assault, and stalking, in accordance with Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972. If you or someone you know is experiencing any of these behaviors, the College has staff and resources on campus to support and assist you. For a list of resources, please visit [Sexual Misconduct Resources](#).

Please note that the [Title IX/Sexual Misconduct Policy 4.1.7](#) designates all faculty members, including teaching assistants, as "Responsible Employees." Under GGC's Title IX/Sexual Misconduct Policy, all "Responsible Employees" must report all disclosures of sex or gender-based discrimination or violence to GGC's Title IX Coordinator. The Title IX Coordinator will reach out to provide resources, support, and information after receiving a report, but community members are not required to respond to such outreach. Reported information will remain private.

If you have (or someone you know has) experienced any form of sex or gender-based discrimination or violence and wish to speak with someone confidentially, please contact GGC's Title IX Coordinator at TitleIX@ggc.edu or 678-407-5085. For more information regarding GGC's Title IX procedures, reporting, or support measures, please visit the [Equal Opportunity and Title IX Compliance office's](#) website.